

What else to watch: *Only Angels Have Wings* (1938) ■ *The Maltese Falcon* (1941, p.331) ■ *To Have and Have Not* (1944) ■ *Brief Encounter* (1945, p.332) ■ *Notorious* (1946) ■ *Key Largo* (1948) ■ *Charade* (1963) ■ *Play It Again, Sam* (1972)



Sam, the pianist at Rick's Café (center), was played by Dooley Wilson. He was a band leader and a drummer, but not a piano player, and had to mime.

and Paul Henreid, who played his rival for Bergman's heart. And yet the movie was an instant success.

At the end of the movie, Bogart's character Rick says, "It doesn't take much to see that the problems of three little people don't amount to a hill of beans in this crazy world." *Casablanca* manages to make its audience feel that the problems of these people are the most important thing they can

imagine. As we discover part way through the movie, Rick, the cynical, hard-drinking owner of Rick's *Café Américain*, an upmarket nightclub, has been stung in Paris by the sudden desertion of his lover, Ilsa (Bergman), as the Germans were invading. Hurt, he has retreated to Casablanca, a town full of spies, Nazi collaborators, Resistance fighters, and desperate refugees.

The shadow of war

"I stick my neck out for nobody," says Rick. In reply to Major Strasser's question, "What is your nationality?" Rick's reply is, "I'm a drunkard."

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It is a movie to play again, and again.

Sheila Johnston
The Daily Telegraph, 2014

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“**Play it, Sam. Play** *As Time Goes By*.”

Ilsa Lund / Casablanca

But in a telling parallel with the real war, such a neutral stance proves impossible. In his bar, different factions end an evening competing with their national »